

Event Concept Note - IDB

Accelerating Nature-Positive Infrastructure: IDB–WWF Collaboration Workshop Series

Version dated: Jul 2, 2026

By IDB with WWF clarifications for WWF participants

Date	Monday, July 13th: Workshop 1 Tuesday, July 14th: Workshop 2 Wednesday, July 15th: Workshop 3
Time	10:30 AM – 12:30 PM (EST)
Duration	2 hours per session
Type of Event	Hybrid (internal technical workshop)
Location	IDB HQ and Online (IDB- Microsoft Teams)
Co-organizers	IDB – WWF US
Audience	IDB: INE and CSD staff WWF staff
Languages	English
Format	Presentations + structured discussion

Agenda format for all workshops

Time	Duration	Theme	Person
10:30 -10:35	5 min	Welcome by IDB	Gregory Watson, Unit Chief, CSD/BNC
10:35 -10:40	5 min	Introduction to the workshop	WWF US- Kate Newman
10:40 -10:50	10 min	Session Objectives	Cristina Contreras - Facilitator
10:50 - 11:10	20 min	Presentation by IDB Case study	TBD
11:10 - 11:30	20 min	Presentation by WWF Case study	TBD
11:30 - 12:15	45 min	Structured Discussion/ Q&A	All attendees Moderated by Sinfranova

12:15-12:30	15 min	Closure & Next Steps	All attendees Moderated by Sinfranova
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Background and Rationale

As part of the IDB–WWF collaboration on Nature and Infrastructure, this three-part workshop series aims to advance the integration of biodiversity and ecosystem service considerations into infrastructure planning, feasibility studies, financing, and implementation.

Despite increasing evidence on the benefits of nature-based solutions (NbS), their integration into infrastructure systems remains limited due to gaps in valuation, financing structures, and enabling environments.

This series addresses these gaps through three sequential lenses:

1. **Workshop 1:** Valuation and feasibility
2. **Workshop 2:** Financial structuring and investment
3. **Workshop 3:** Enabling frameworks and implementation

The workshops are designed to collectively contribute to defining a joint IDB–WWF collaboration roadmap for 2026–2027.

Objectives

- Strengthen the integration of ecosystem service valuation in infrastructure planning
- Identify how NbS can be translated into bankable investment opportunities
- Define the policy, regulatory, and institutional conditions required to scale NbS
- Generate concrete inputs for a joint IDB–WWF workplan

Proposed Agenda

1. Workshop 1 – Feasibility and Valuation Frameworks (Monday, July 13th)

Objective

To explore how ecosystem service valuation and spatial planning tools can strengthen feasibility studies, guide landscape prioritization, and inform cost-benefit analysis for nature-positive infrastructure.

- Identify priority landscapes for nature-based infrastructure
- Strengthen feasibility studies and early project design
- Inform cost–benefit analysis comparing green, grey, and hybrid solutions

Key Content

- Valuation tools and feasibility studies
- Hydrology, sediment retention, and risk reduction
- Spatial planning for infrastructure (transport, water, energy)
- WWF spatial prioritization methodologies

Structured Discussion – Guiding Questions

- How to combine valuation and spatial planning to guide decisions?
- What metrics should be standardized?
- What are key methodological gaps?
- What joint analytical products should be developed?

2. Workshop 2 – Structuring the Capital Stack for Investment (Tuesday, July 14th)

Objective

To translate ecological and economic valuation into financial valuation, identifying blended finance strategies and mechanisms to mobilize private investment in nature-positive infrastructure.

Key Content

- Bankability challenges of NbS (long-term returns, risk asymmetries)
- Blended finance and derisking instruments
- Public-private partnerships and investment vehicles
- Embedding ecological assets into financial structures

Structured Discussion – Guiding Questions

- How to convert ecosystem service value into financial value?
- What barriers prevent private investment?
- Which blended finance models are most effective?
- How can IDB and WWF co-develop investment pipelines?

3. Workshop 3 – Market-Enabling Frameworks and Implementation (Wednesday, July 15th)

Objective

To identify the policy, regulatory, institutional, and financial conditions required to scale nature-based solutions across sectors.

Key Content

- Policy frameworks (mitigation hierarchy, land-use planning)
- Procurement reforms
- Credit rating and insurance incentives
- Project preparation facilities for biodiversity

Structured Discussion – Guiding Questions

- What policy reforms are most urgent?
- How to make NbS eligible and competitive in procurement?
- How to recognize NbS as risk-reducing assets?
- What enabling conditions allow scalability and replication?

Standard Session Format (All Workshops)

Time	Content
Opening (15 min)	Framing and objectives
Case Studies (40 min)	IDB + WWF
Structured Discussion (40 min)	Guided questions
Closure	Key takeaways

Expected Outcomes

Shared understanding of:

- Valuation methodologies
- Financing mechanisms
- Enabling policy frameworks

Identification of:

- Priority collaboration areas
- Concrete analytical products
- Potential investment opportunities

Contributions to:

- A joint IDB–WWF roadmap (2026–2027)
- Pipeline development for nature-positive infrastructure